

Filipe Hisao Kobayashi

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Appointments

- 2024– **University of Salzburg**
Post-doctorate researcher
- 2023–2024 **University of Pennsylvania**
Lecturer in Syntax/Semantics

Education

DEGREE PROGRAMS

- 2017–2023 **Massachusetts Institute of Technology**
PhD program in Linguistics
Dissertation: “Quantifying over individual concepts”
- 2016–2017 **University of Toronto**
MA in Hispanic Linguistics
- 2012–2016 **Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro**
BA in Portuguese Language and Literature (Letras)
Thesis: “Possessive time, cessation and lifetime effects”

SUMMER SCHOOLS

- 2019 **DGfS Summer School**, Berlin, Germany
- 2018 **NASSLLI**, Pittsburgh, USA

Papers

UNPUBLISHED MANUSCRIPTS

- 2026 “Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts”
Submitted

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- 2024 “Ignorance under attitudes”
[with Patrick D. Elliott]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2024

- 2024 “Tracking down (c)overt movement with adverbial distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese”
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 39
- 2021 “Lexically triggered uniqueness in wh-questions: An argument from Brazilian Portuguese”
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 31
- 2021 “Two ways of building reciprocity: a study of Mandarin reciprocals”
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 38
- 2021 “Composing reciprocity: An analysis of scattered reciprocals”
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30
- 2020 “High and low uniqueness in singular wh-interrogatives”
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30
- 2020 “Tying Free Choice in questions to distributivity” [with Vincent Rouillard]
New Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence (Proceedings of Logic and Engineering of Natural Language Semantics 16)
- 2020 “Ways of decomposing events: distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese”
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
Chicago Linguistics Society 55
- 2020 “Comprehending and: The Acquisition of English Conjunction in Child Language”
[with Sherry Yong Chen, Loes Koring, Cory Bill, Leo Rosenstein and Martin Hackl]
Boston University Conference on Language Development 44
- 2019 “Coordinating Complete Answers: The Case of Tanto-Quanto Conjunction”
[with Enrico Flor]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2019
- 2016 “Temporal implicatures and possessive time in Brazilian Portuguese”
Semantics of Under-Represented Languages in the Americas 9

Presentations

TALKS

- 2025 “Building individual concepts structurally”
Ontology As Structured by the Interfaces with Semantics 5
- 2025 “From NPs to predicates of individual concepts”
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 35
- 2024 “Nominal Free Choice”
[with Patrick D. Elliott]
MECORE closing workshop
- 2022 “The logic of Hindi co-compounds”
[with Ido Benbaji and Yash Sinha]
Sinn und Bedeutung 27

- 2021 “Tracking down (c)overt movement with adverbial distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese”
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 39
- 2021 “Two ways of building reciprocity: a study of Mandarin reciprocals”
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 38
- 2019 “Coordinating Complete Answers: The Case of Tanto-Quanto Conjunction”
[with Enrico Flor]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2019
- 2019 “Tying Free Choice in questions to distributivity” [with Vincent Rouillard]
Logic and Engineering of Natural Language Semantics 16
- 2019 “A compositional analysis of scattered reciprocals in Brazilian Portuguese”
Workshop on Cross-Linguistic Semantics of Reciprocals
- 2019 “Ways of decomposing events: distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese”
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
Chicago Linguistics Society 55
- POSTERS
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- 2025 “Syntactic constraints on fake indexicals in relative clauses”
[with Caroline Gardner, Franziska Keller, Anita Riedl and Susanne Wurmbrand]
North East Linguistic Society 56
- 2024 “Ignorance under attitudes”
[with Patrick D. Elliott]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2024
- 2024 “Quantification uncovered: a reply to Aloni (2001)”
[with Enrico Flor]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 34
- 2021 “Which singular *wh*-interrogatives admit plural answers in Brazilian Portuguese”
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 31
- 2020 “Getting plural answers from singular complex *wh*-phrases in Brazilian Portuguese”
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Sensus 1
- 2020 “Composing reciprocity: An analysis of scattered reciprocals”
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30
- 2020 “High and low uniqueness in singular *wh*-interrogatives”
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30
- 2020 “Quantifying over thematic roles: Mandarin distributive numerals and reciprocals”
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
Generative Linguistics in the Old World 43

- 2020 “Comprehension of Conjunction by English-speaking Adults and Children”
[with Sherry Yong Chen, Loes Koring, Cory Bill, Leo Rosenstein and Martin Hackl]
CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing 33
- 2020 “Comprehending and: The Acquisition of English Conjunction in Child Language”
[with Sherry Yong Chen, Loes Koring, Cory Bill, Leo Rosenstein and Martin Hackl]
Boston University Conference on Language Development 44
- 2019 “Two types of reciprocals in Mandarin Chinese”
Workshop on Cross-Linguistic Semantics of Reciprocals
- 2018 “Distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese at the syntax-semantics interface”
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
NASSLLI Student Session
- 2016 “Temporal implicatures and possessive time in Brazilian Portuguese”
Semantics of Under-Represented Languages in the Americas 9
- INVITED TALKS
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- 2026 “Generalizing von Stechow’s problem”
Talk at the Georg-August University Göttingen
- 2024 “Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts”
Talk at the Leibniz-Zentrum Allgemeine Sprachwissenschaft (ZAS)
- 2024 “Quantification uncovered”
Meaning in Language colloquium at the Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf
- 2024 “Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts”
NYU Semantics Group at the New York University
- 2024 “Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts”
ILST Seminar in Language and Communication Sciences at the University of Pennsylvania

Teaching experience

MAIN INSTRUCTOR

- 2024 Introduction to Formal Linguistics, UPenn (Undergraduate class)
- 2024 Syntax 2, UPenn (Graduate Class)
- 2023 Construct a Language, UPenn (Undergraduate class)
- 2023 Seminar in Syntax and Semantics, UPenn (Graduate class)
- 2023 Winter Logic Crash-Course, MIT
Co-instructor with Vincent Rouillard
(a two-week logic introduction course)

SUMMER SCHOOLS

- 2026 Course title TBA
OVA summer school
- 2025 The Morphology, Syntax and Semantics of Fake ϕ -features in pronouns
Co-instructor with Susi Wurmbrand
The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies #10

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

- 2021 Undergraduate Semantics & Pragmatics, MIT
Instructor: Patrick D. Elliott
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, grading, office hours
- 2020 Introduction to Linguistics, MIT
Instructor: Adam Albright
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, grading, office hours
- 2019 Introduction to Semantics, MIT
Instructor: Martin Hackl & Roger Schwarzschild
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, office hours
- 2018 Introduction to Linguistics, MIT
Instructor: Adam Albright
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, grading, office hours
- 2016 Linguistics III (formal syntax), Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Suzi Lima
Responsibilities: office hours
- 2015–2016 Linguistics II (phonetics and phonology), Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Gean Nunes Damulakis
Responsibilities: office hours
- 2015 History of the Portuguese Language, Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Leonardo Lennertz Marcotulio
Responsibilities: office hours
- 2014 Linguistics III (formal syntax), Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Aleria Lage
Responsibilities: office hours
- 2014 Intensive Linguistics Course for Indigenous Educators, UNEMAT
Instructor: Prof. Marília Facó Soares
Responsibilities: teaching assistant

GUEST LECTURES

- 2023 “Interleaving A- & A’-movement: a Brazilian Portuguese case study”
Syntax II, Yale, Instructor: Suzana Fong
- 2022 “The Dynamics of Plurals”
Topics in Semantics (graduate seminar on anaphora), MIT, Instructor: Patrick D. Elliott
- 2022 “Interrogative Intruders”
Advanced Semantics, MIT, Instructors: Amy Rose Deal, Martin Hackl

Service

ORGANIZING

- 2020 Co-founder and co-organizer of the Semantics Triangle, an MIT-Harvard-BU semantics reading group

- 2019–2020 Co-organizer of LF Reading Group, MIT's semantics reading group
- 2018–2020 Co-founder and co-organizer of MorPhun, MIT's morphology reading group
- 2019 Co-organizer of MIT Linguistics' Colloquium Talks

Languages

Brazilian native
Portuguese
English fluent
Spanish advanced

(last updated on March 20, 2026)